NETHERBLOOM

Book of Remembrance



The Garland Girl

The old grave-texts told the dead: do not drink from Lethe; find the spring of Memory. This Book is that spring.

THE SOUL OF THIS BOOK

The Garland Girl

She wove a flower for everyone but herself.

She grew up in a house full of drying herbs. Her father hung them from every beam, and in the evenings he taught her their names: rosemary for remembering, pansies for thoughts, fennel and columbine, rue for sorrow, and the daisy that is only for those who are loved. By the time she could walk to the brook alone she could weave any of them into a garland, and she made one for everyone she loved.

A young man came to the house who spoke the way songs do. He promised her things in the garden, and she believed every word, and wove him a garland of violets. Then her father died, suddenly, in a dark corridor, and the young man looked at her in front of everyone as though he had never seen her before. He pretended not to know her. That was worse than anything he could have said.

After that she sang. She sang the old songs, half of them wrong, and went through the house giving her flowers away: rosemary to her brother, fennel to the king, rue to the queen and a little for herself. One afternoon she went down to the willow that leaned over the brook, to hang the last of her garlands on its branches. The branch broke. Her dress spread out on the water and held her up a while, and she went on singing, as if she did not understand what was happening, until the water grew too heavy.

Everyone remembered her flowers. No one ever asked which one she had kept for herself. The old ferryman would not carry her; there was no coin under her tongue, only a petal. So she waits with you, still singing, her hands full of wet flowers.



What the Ferrymen know

She has always understood the Book better than anyone; she lived by the meanings of things. Her pages are blessed when only two memories are written there, for she never needed many words to say what she meant.

Twist: The Chapter Blessing comes after only 2 inscribed memories.

Key Memory: *the one flower I kept for myself*



Keeping the Book

The Book has one page per Reach. Each page has four slots, **Place**, **Person**, **Deed** and **Feeling**, which fill a sentence about the soul's life.

You may **inscribe** a card when it Resonates, if its memory's slot is still empty on the current page. A **Key Memory** card may be inscribed whenever it is played face up. An inscribed card leaves the deck for good: you trade a useful card for a memory the soul will keep.

Chapter Blessing. When a page holds 3 memories (2 for the Garland Girl), the river grants the first of these that applies: mend a Fracture, drain Black Water, or return a forgotten card.

At the end, the Book is read aloud. Slots never filled read "...but this, the river has taken".

Tuck an inscribed card into the well for its slot: slide its four corners under the slits. Slide it out again to reuse the card next game.

I · Who I Was

I was born near...



I loved...



I once...



and ever since I have carried...



☐ Chapter Blessing

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

II · What I Did

At...

PLACE

...but this, the river has taken

before...



PERSON

...but this, the river has taken

I...



DEED

...but this, the river has taken

The price was...



FEELING

...but this, the river has taken

☐ Chapter Blessing

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

III · What I Carry

I go now, leaving...



forgiving...



unable to undo the day I...



holding only...



The Far Shore

At the Far Shore the Keeper lifts the veil and offers the cup. What the soul remembers decides how it drinks.

- ☐ **Inscribed in the Book**: kept and spoken. The soul crosses remembering what mattered most.
- ☐ **Forgotten**: lost to the river. The soul goes on, lighter and emptier, without it.
- ☐ **Never written** (still in the deck, a hand or the discard pile): never faced. Some things go across unsaid.

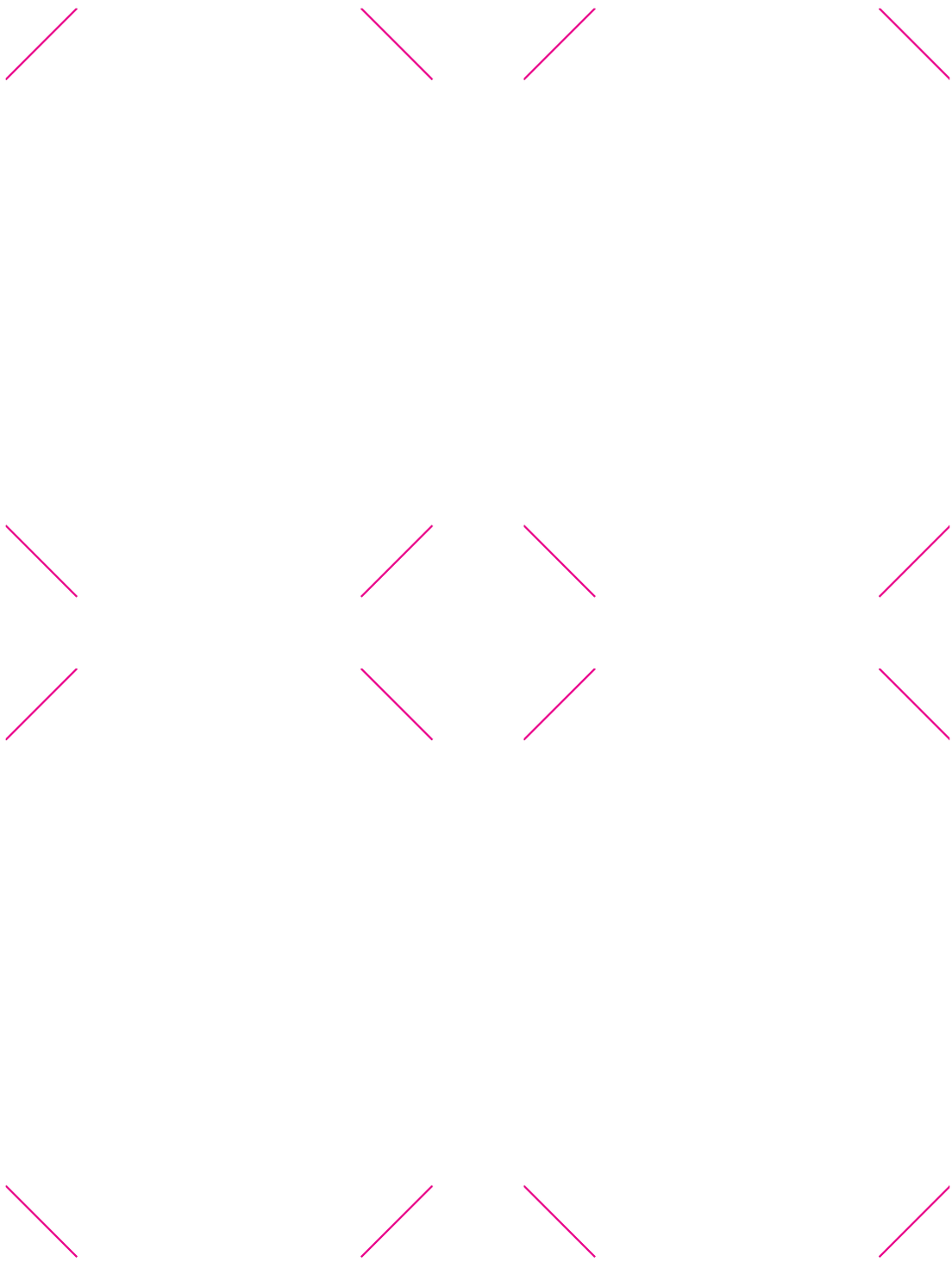
Then read the Book aloud, page by page. Even a lost crossing leaves a story: blanks read "...but this, the river has taken", and the epilogue tells how the soul was lost. Every game writes a different life.

FERRYMEN _____ LANTERN _____ DATE _____



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RALPH LAUXIE



DIE LINE · pages 4–6 · photo-corner slits (magenta), 11 mm diagonals at each corner of the four 66 × 91 mm wells